

Harpoon A type of spear.

Herbivore An animal that eats plants or algae, rather than other animals.

Hotspot A zone of volcanic activity caused by a stationary plume of heat beneath Earth's crust.

Hurricane A severe tropical storm.

Iceberg Part of a glacier or ice shelf that has broken off and floated out to sea.

Ice floe A floating fragment of sea ice.

Ice sheet A very large, deep covering of ice over a continent.

Immune Not affected by something.

Incubate To keep an egg warm so it develops and hatches.

Invertebrate An animal that does not have a jointed internal skeleton.

Island arc A line of islands marking a boundary between two plates of Earth's crust. It is created by volcanic activity as one plate plunges beneath the other and is destroyed.

Keratin The natural substance that forms fingernails, hair, and turtle shells.

Lagoon An area of shallow water that has been cut off from the sea.

Lava Molten rock that erupts from a volcano.

Limestone A rock composed of calcite (lime) that can be made by reef corals.

Magma Molten rock that lies within or beneath Earth's crust.

Mammal One of a group of warm-blooded, often hairy vertebrates that feed their young on milk supplied by the mother.

Mangrove Any of various trees growing on muddy shores in the tropics and adapted to live with their roots and lower trunks immersed in salt water.

Mantle The deep layer of hot rock that lies between Earth's crust and the core.

Meteorite A fragment of space rock that plunges through the atmosphere and hits the ground.

Microbe A microscopic living thing.

Microbial Something formed of microbes.

Mid-ocean ridge A ridge of submarine mountains on the ocean floor, created by a spreading rift between two plates of Earth's crust.

Migrate To make a regular, often annual journey in search of food or a suitable place to breed.

Mineral A natural solid made of one or more elements in fixed proportions, usually with a distinctive crystal structure.

Molecule A particle formed from a fixed number of atoms. One oxygen and two hydrogen atoms form a water molecule.

Mollusk A soft-bodied animal that may have a shell, such as a snail or a clam. An octopus is an advanced type of mollusk.

Molten The state of having melted, as in hot, liquid rock.

Naturalist Someone who studies the natural world.

Northern hemisphere The region of Earth north of the equator.

Nutrients Substances that living things need to build their tissues.

Oceanic crust The relatively thin crust of solid basalt that lies above Earth's mantle and forms the bedrock of the ocean floor.

Oceanography Ocean science.

Octopod A marine animal with eight "feet" or arms, similar to an octopus.

Omnivore An animal that feeds on both plants and animals.

Ooze A soft sediment formed from the remains of living things such as plankton.

Organism A living thing.

Outlet glacier A glacier that drains ice from a much bigger ice sheet.

Pack ice Thick floating ice that has been formed by the freezing of the ocean surface. It can take the form of separate ice floes or a virtually solid sheet.

Parasite A living thing that feeds off other live organisms without killing them first.

Pectoral fins Paired fins near a fish's head.

Peridotite The rock that forms much of Earth's deep mantle.

Photophore An organ that produces light.

Photosynthesis The process by which plants and algae use light to make sugar from carbon dioxide and water.

Phytoplankton Microscopic, single-celled organisms that drift in the sunlit surface waters of oceans and lakes. They use photosynthesis to make food.

Plankton Living things that drift in lakes and oceans, usually near the surface.

Pollution Waste substances that have been dumped into water, air, or on land. They can often have a harmful effect on the environment.

Polyp The tubular body form of a sea anemone or single coral. Colonial corals are made up of many polyps.

Predator An animal that kills other animals for food.

Prevailing wind A wind that blows from a particular direction for most of the time.

Prey An animal eaten by another animal.

Protein A complex substance that a living thing makes out of simpler nutrients, and uses to form its tissues.

Protist Usually a type of single-celled organism that is more complex than bacteria, but also includes multi-celled marine algae (seaweed).

Protozoan An animal-like single-celled organism, usually microscopic.